Pre-registration Go / No-Go Checklist

Fillable PDF. Click a blue box to type; tick the small squares. Save with **File › Save** and attach the saved PDF to your assignment. Works best in the free Adobe Acrobat Reader; macOS Preview and web browsers also work. If an answer does not fit its box, continue it on an extra page. Source: `Step_05_Preregistration_and_Open_Science/preregistration_checklist.md` (rebuild with `tools/make_fillable_pdfs.py`).

Complete this checklist **before submitting** the preregistration and **before starting data collection**. Every item must be ☐ or explicitly justified as N/A.

Section 1 — Hypotheses and theory

- ☐ Every confirmatory hypothesis is stated in a falsifiable, directional form.
- ☐ Each hypothesis is grounded in theory documented in `Step_02_Theory_Grounding/`.
- ☐ No hypothesis was written after preliminary data inspection (pilot data viewed ≠ data collection begun).
- ☐ The distinction between confirmatory and exploratory questions is clearly drawn.

Section 2 — Measures and instruments

- ☐ All primary and secondary outcome measures are named and fully specified (item wording, response scale, scoring).
- ☐ All covariates and moderators are listed.
- ☐ Psychometric justification for each scale is documented in `Step_03_Psychometric_Scales/`.
- ☐ Manipulation checks (if experimental) are specified.
- ☐ Open-ended / qualitative items planned for analysis are listed, and the analysis method is described.

Section 3 — Sampling and power

- ☐ Target N is derived from a power analysis in `Step_09_Power_and_Sampling/`.
- ☐ Minimum acceptable N is stated.
- ☐ Stopping rule is unambiguous (fixed N / quota / sequential with explicit rule).
- ☐ Inclusion and exclusion criteria are operationally defined (no vague terms like "poor quality responses").
- ☐ Attention check rules and data-cleaning decisions are written down before seeing the data.

Section 4 — Analysis plan

- ☐ Every confirmatory hypothesis maps to exactly one primary statistical test.
- ☐ The statistical model (formula, covariates, link function, etc.) is fully specified.
- ☐ The alpha level and any multiple-comparison correction are stated.
- ☐ Assumption checks and their remedies are pre-specified (Section 8.3 of template).
- ☐ Pre-specified contingency analyses are written for foreseeable measurement failures.
- ☐ Exploratory analyses are listed separately and clearly labeled.

Section 5 — Study design

- ☐ Randomization plan is documented (if applicable) in `Step_04_Study_Design/design_docs/randomization_plan.md`.
- ☐ Survey flow is documented in `Step_04_Study_Design/design_docs/survey_flow_diagram.md`.

- [ ] Any blinding procedures are described.

Section 6 — Open science materials

- [ ] A plan for sharing (or embargo justification for not sharing) the instrument, data, and scripts is stated.
- [ ] Analysis scripts (even skeleton scripts) are version-controlled before data collection.

Section 7 — Submission

- [ ] Preregistration document has been reviewed by at least one co-author.
- [ ] Document uploaded to OSF or AsPredicted and a time-stamped URL obtained.
- [ ] URL recorded in Section 1 of `preregistration_template.md`.
- [ ] A copy of the submitted document is saved in this folder with the date in the filename (e.g., `preregistration_submitted_YYYY-MM-DD.md`).

Section 8 — Deviations from the preregistered plan

Real data collection rarely goes exactly as planned. The goal is not to avoid deviations but to report them transparently (Willroth & Atherton, 2024).

- [ ] Any deviation from the preregistered sample size, measures, exclusion criteria, or analysis plan is logged as it happens (not reconstructed after the fact).
- [ ] Each deviation is classified: unplanned exclusion, measure change, analysis change, or sample-size change.
- [ ] The manuscript reports deviations explicitly (e.g., in a "Deviations from preregistration" subsection) rather than silently reporting the as-run analysis as if it were the pre-specified one.
- [ ] Multi-site/multi-lab or replication-style studies additionally report inter-site variability in effect estimates, since a single "reproducible" result at one site does not guarantee reproducibility elsewhere (Mundinger et al., 2025, found meaningful cross-laboratory variation in a multi-lab reproducibility test of insect behavior assays — a useful cautionary worked example for any multi-site socio-ecological survey).

Sign-off

Role	Name	Date
Principal Investigator		
Co-investigator / reviewer		

References: Willroth & Atherton (2024); Mundinger et al. (2025).